

DISCIPLINE CASE DIGEST



Case: AE 2020-01
Subject Member: Former Registered Forest Professional
Complainant: ABCFP member
Nature of Complaint: Unauthorized use of title, Act Enforcement
Standards Referred to: *Foresters Act* s19(2), 20(1)
Date of Decision: January 2020
Outcome: Act Enforcement

Complaint

In early 2020, it was brought to the ABCFP's attention that a former member, David Andermatt, had for some time been using the protected professional title "Registered Professional Forester" and the initials "RPF" on the website for his tree management services business, Pacific Sun Tree Services, and that he had also been using the "RPF" title when signing work documents.

In fact, Mr. Andermatt ceased to be a registered member of the ABCFP in February 2011, when he voluntarily resigned his membership. He has not been a member of the ABCFP since that time.

As a result of his resignation, Mr. Andermatt is prohibited by the *Foresters Act* from using the titles "Professional Forester", "Registered Professional Forester" or "RPF", or from engaging in the independent practice of professional forestry.

Mr. Andermatt was served with a notice requesting his comply with these requirements, and he has confirmed that he will comply in future.

Discussion

The public of BC expects that the ABCFP will protect its interests in the management of forests by ensuring that only those individuals who are qualified, competent and accountable use the protected titles prescribed in our legislation. Each year, the ABCFP encounters circumstances where it must take enforcement action with individuals who misrepresent themselves through the use of a protected title. As a self-regulating profession, the ABCFP depends on the public and its members to identify cases of title infringement.